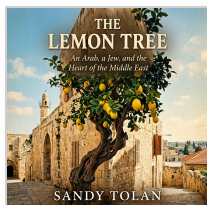


Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995 - Guided Reading Extract



The Lemon Tree

By Sandy Tolan

"The British Mandate was fraying at the edges. Tensions in Jerusalem had reached a boiling point, culminating in the devastating explosion at the King David Hotel. Meanwhile, off the coast, ships carrying desperate refugees were being turned away, their passengers caught in a geopolitical struggle far beyond their control."

Comprehension & Inference

1. What event is described as the 'boiling point' of tensions in Jerusalem?

2. Who was on the ships being turned away off the coast?

3. How does the author describe the state of the British Mandate?



Mornings in Jenin

By Susan Abulhawa

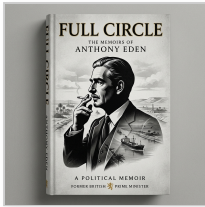
"The exodus was a chaotic river of humanity. Families fled with only what they could carry, clutching iron keys to the homes they believed they would return to in a matter of weeks. Instead, the temporary canvas tents of the refugee camps slowly turned into permanent concrete blocks, cementing their exile."

Comprehension & Inference

1. How does the author describe the exodus of the refugees?

2. Why did the families carry the iron keys to their homes?

3. What physical transformation in the camps symbolized their permanent exile?



Full Circle

By Anthony Eden

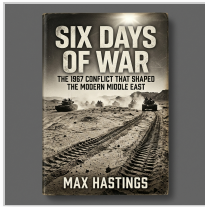
"Nasser's seizure of the Suez Canal was not merely an act of nationalization; it was a brazen act of international theft that threatened the economic survival of Western Europe. If we allowed dictators to break international agreements without consequence, we would be repeating the tragic appeasement of the 1930s."

Comprehension & Inference

1. How does Anthony Eden describe Nasser's seizure of the Suez Canal?

2. What historical mistake does Eden claim he was trying to avoid repeating?

3. Why might historians be skeptical of the arguments presented in a politician's memoir?



Six Days of War: June 1967 and the Making of the Modern Middle East

By Michael B. Oren

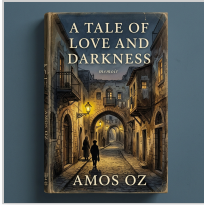
"The pre-emptive strike by the Israeli Air Force was unprecedented in its precision and devastation. Within mere hours on that June morning, the Egyptian air force was annihilated on the ground. The element of surprise was total, effectively deciding the outcome of the war before the ground forces had even engaged."

Comprehension & Inference

1. What military action decided the outcome of the Six Day War almost immediately?

2. Why was the Israeli air strike so effective?

3. What does the phrase 'pre-emptive strike' suggest about how Israel viewed the threat from its neighbors?



A Tale of Love and Darkness

By Amos Oz

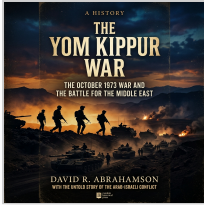
"The euphoria following the 1967 victory was intoxicating. The cramped, besieged borders of the early state had suddenly expanded. Yet, amidst the jubilation of returning to the Western Wall and the old city of Jerusalem, there was a quiet, creeping realization that occupying another people would exact a heavy moral and political toll on the nation's soul."

Comprehension & Inference

1. How did Israelis react immediately after the 1967 victory?

2. What specific location is mentioned as a cause for jubilation?

3. What 'creeping realization' does Amos Oz reflect upon regarding the newly captured territories?



The Yom Kippur War

By Abraham Rabinovich

"The sirens wailed across the empty streets on the holiest day of the Jewish calendar, shattering the illusions of invincibility born in 1967. The coordinated surprise attack by Egypt and Syria caught the intelligence establishment completely off guard. Young soldiers, hastily mobilized, were thrown into a desperate battle for the survival of the state."

Comprehension & Inference

1. Why was the timing of the attack so shocking and disruptive for Israel?

2. What 'illusions' were shattered by the attack?

3. How does the author describe the initial military response by the mobilized soldiers?



Thirteen Days in September: Carter, Begin, and Sadat at Camp David

By Lawrence Wright

"The atmosphere in the secluded cabins of Camp David was suffocatingly tense. Menachem Begin and Anwar Sadat, both fiercely proud and deeply scarred by decades of bloodshed, frequently refused to speak directly to one another. It fell to Jimmy Carter to endlessly shuttle between their cabins, slowly hammering out a compromise that would demand unimaginable political courage from both leaders."

Comprehension & Inference

1. How does the author describe the relationship between Begin and Sadat at the start of the summit?

2. What role did US President Jimmy Carter play in the negotiations?

3. Why did the final compromise require 'unimaginable political courage'?



Palestine

By Joe Sacco

"The streets were a chaotic blur of burning tires, tear gas, and flying stones. This wasn't an army fighting an army; it was a generation of angry teenagers with slingshots confronting heavily armored patrols. The air was thick with the scent of rebellion and the suffocating realization that the old political order was crumbling under the weight of this grassroots uprising."

Comprehension & Inference

1. How did the First Intifada differ from previous Arab-Israeli conflicts?

2. What imagery does the author use to describe the chaotic streets?

3. What does the phrase 'grassroots uprising' suggest about the leaders of the Intifada?



The Declaration of Principles (The Oslo Accords)

By Yitzhak Rabin and Yasser Arafat

"The Government of the State of Israel and the P.L.O. team... representing the Palestinian people, agree that it is time to put an end to decades of confrontation and conflict, recognize their mutual legitimate and political rights, and strive to live in peaceful coexistence and mutual dignity and security and achieve a just, lasting and comprehensive peace settlement and historic reconciliation..."

Comprehension & Inference

1. According to the text, what did both sides agree it was 'time' to do?

2. What 'rights' are recognized in this document?

3. What is the ultimate goal of the Declaration of Principles as stated in this extract?
